

Influenza (Flu) Suspected - Female (Child)

Algorithm 1416 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Suspected influenza (flu) assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published flu guidance.
- Child patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [DURATION] How long have symptoms lasted?
2. [TEMPERATURE] What is the temperature, if measured?
3. [OPEN_TEXT] Any chronic conditions or weakened immunity?
4. [CAREGIVER_OBSERVATION] What has a safe parent or caregiver observed about alertness, breathing, pain, swelling, fever, eating or drinking, sleep, play, and normal activity?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → COVID-19 - Diagnosed or Suspected

Is confirmed or suspected COVID-19 the primary concern?

Confirmed or suspected COVID-19 belongs in the authored COVID-19 - Diagnosed or Suspected pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is there sudden chest pain, severe or abnormal breathing (gasping, choking, unable to speak or feed normally), coughing up blood, blue or grey colour, confusion, collapse, a seizure, severe dehydration, or is a baby or child unusually floppy, difficult to wake, feeding poorly, or rapidly worsening?

NHS.UK flu and emergency guidance treats severe breathing, chest pain, haemoptysis and rapid serious deterioration as emergency features; infant colour, responsiveness, feeding and hydration changes can be signs of serious illness.

1. Disposition level 70

After emergency features are excluded, is the patient under 3 months with a measured temperature of 38 degrees Celsius or higher, age 3-6 months with a measured temperature of 39 degrees Celsius or higher, or is the person 65 or older, pregnant or recently gave birth, living with a long-term condition or weakened immune system, feeling very unwell or short of breath, or have symptoms not improved after 7 days?

NICE treats fever at these infant age thresholds as higher risk, and NHS.UK guidance recommends urgent clinical review for the other higher-risk groups or persistent symptoms.

1. Disposition level 15

Are these typical flu symptoms with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance describes rest and fluids as appropriate first-line self-care for flu.

Advice

Qatar emergency response for severe influenza-like illness

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 now for severe or abnormal breathing, blue or grey colour, severe chest pain, confusion, collapse, seizure, coughing blood, severe dehydration, or a baby or child who is floppy, difficult to wake, feeding poorly, or rapidly worsening. Follow 999 instructions and do not drive. If unresponsive and not breathing normally, start age-appropriate CPR as directed and use an AED if available. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: worsening or abnormal breathing; blue or grey colour, confusion, collapse, or seizure; coughing blood or severe dehydration; rapid deterioration in a baby, child, pregnant person, older adult, or immunocompromised person.

Urgent flu review for higher-risk groups

- Arrange same-day medical review given the higher-risk factors present.
- Call Back If: symptoms worsen; breathing difficulty develops.

Supportive care pending Qatar governance approval

- Rest, take frequent suitable fluids, and reduce contact with others while feverish or unwell. Medicine choice and dose require age, weight, allergy, pregnancy, kidney/liver disease, ulcer/bleeding risk, other medicines, and Qatar formulary checks; never give aspirin to a child or teenager with a viral illness, and do not combine products containing the same ingredient. This branch is UAT-only and requires an approved Qatar non-emergency route.
- Call Back If: breathing difficulty, chest pain, confusion, or dehydration; symptoms worsen or fail to improve; concern in pregnancy, infancy, frailty, or immunocompromise.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 now for severe or abnormal breathing, blue or grey colour, severe chest pain, confusion, collapse, seizure, coughing blood, severe dehydration, or a baby or child who is floppy,

difficult to wake, feeding poorly, or rapidly worsening. Follow 999 instructions and do not drive. If unresponsive and not breathing normally, start age-appropriate CPR as directed and use an AED if available. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Flu", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/flu/> (page last reviewed 03 February 2026)
- NICE NG143, "Fever in under 5s: assessment and initial management", <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/ng143>

Provenance

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